

USA: State flags

The date when each state joined the Union is shown below the state name.



ALABAMA

1819

This flag, which was adopted in 1895, shows a red saltire on a white field. It is intended to recall the Southern Cross or Battle Flag of the Confederate States.



ARIZONA

1912

The red and yellow rays recall the period of Spanish rule and the copper star stands for mineral riches. The flag was designed locally and adopted in 1927.



CALIFORNIA

1850

The flag is based on that of the California Republic declared at Sonoma in 1846; it did not become the state flag until 1911. It depicts a grizzly bear and a star for freedom.



CONNECTICUT

1788

The arms date back to the seal of 1784, and the blue field to the Civil War period, when the flag was a Union color. This design was adopted in 1897.



ALASKA

1959

The flag was designed by a Native American schoolboy in 1926, when Alaska was still a territory. It depicts the Plow and the northern Pole star. Gold also represents Alaska's mineral reserves.



ARKANSAS

1836

The flag recalls the Southern Cross. The lower stars represent former colonial powers and the upper star stands for the Confederacy. The flag was adopted in 1913.



COLORADO

1876

The C-shaped emblem contains the colors of Spain, which once laid claim to this area. The gold ball also represents the state's mineral riches. The flag was adopted in 1911.



DELAWARE

1787

The arms date back to 1777 and the flag, adopted in 1913, includes the date Delaware joined the Union. The colors recall the uniforms worn during the War of Independence.